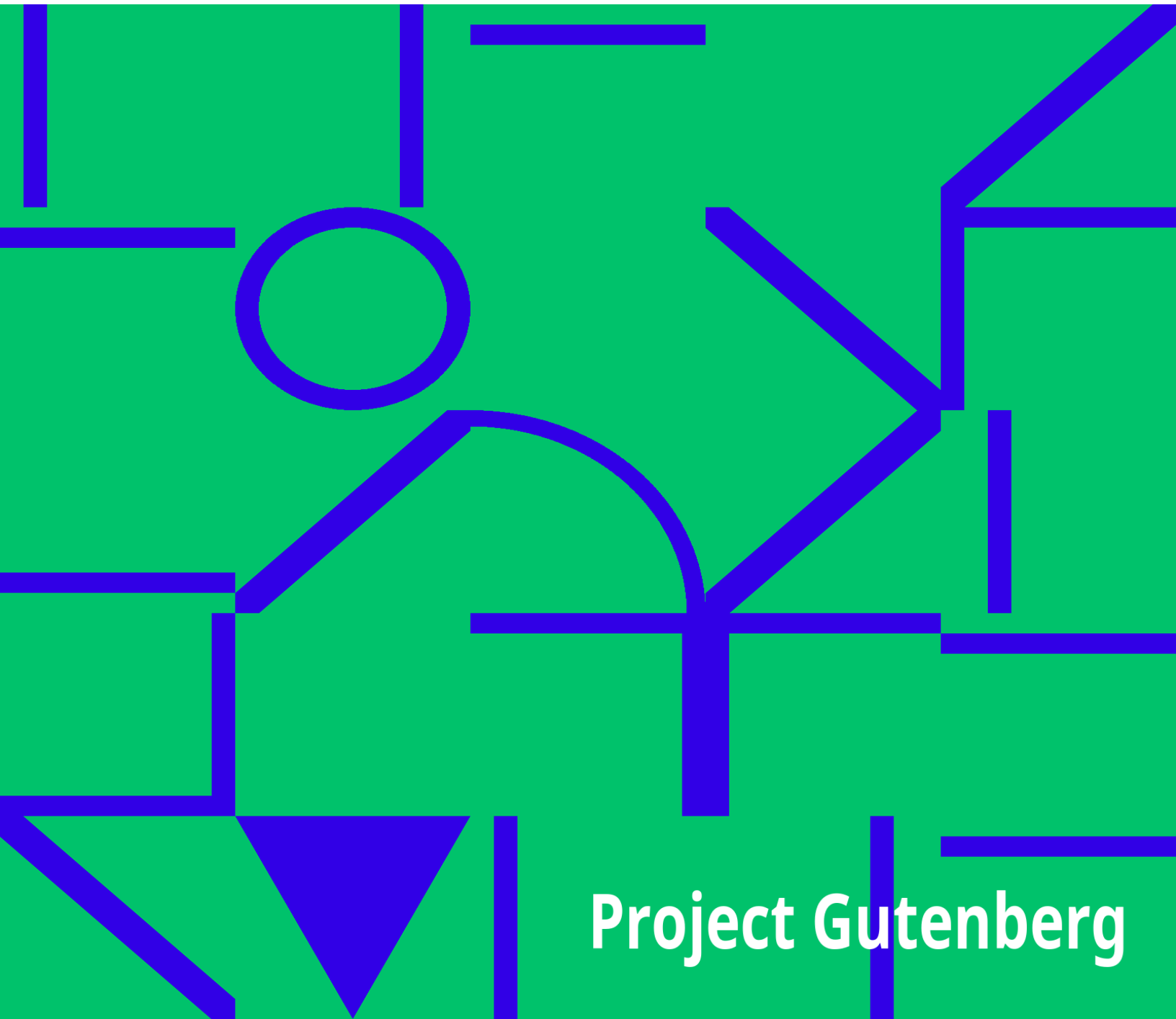


The New Morning: Poems

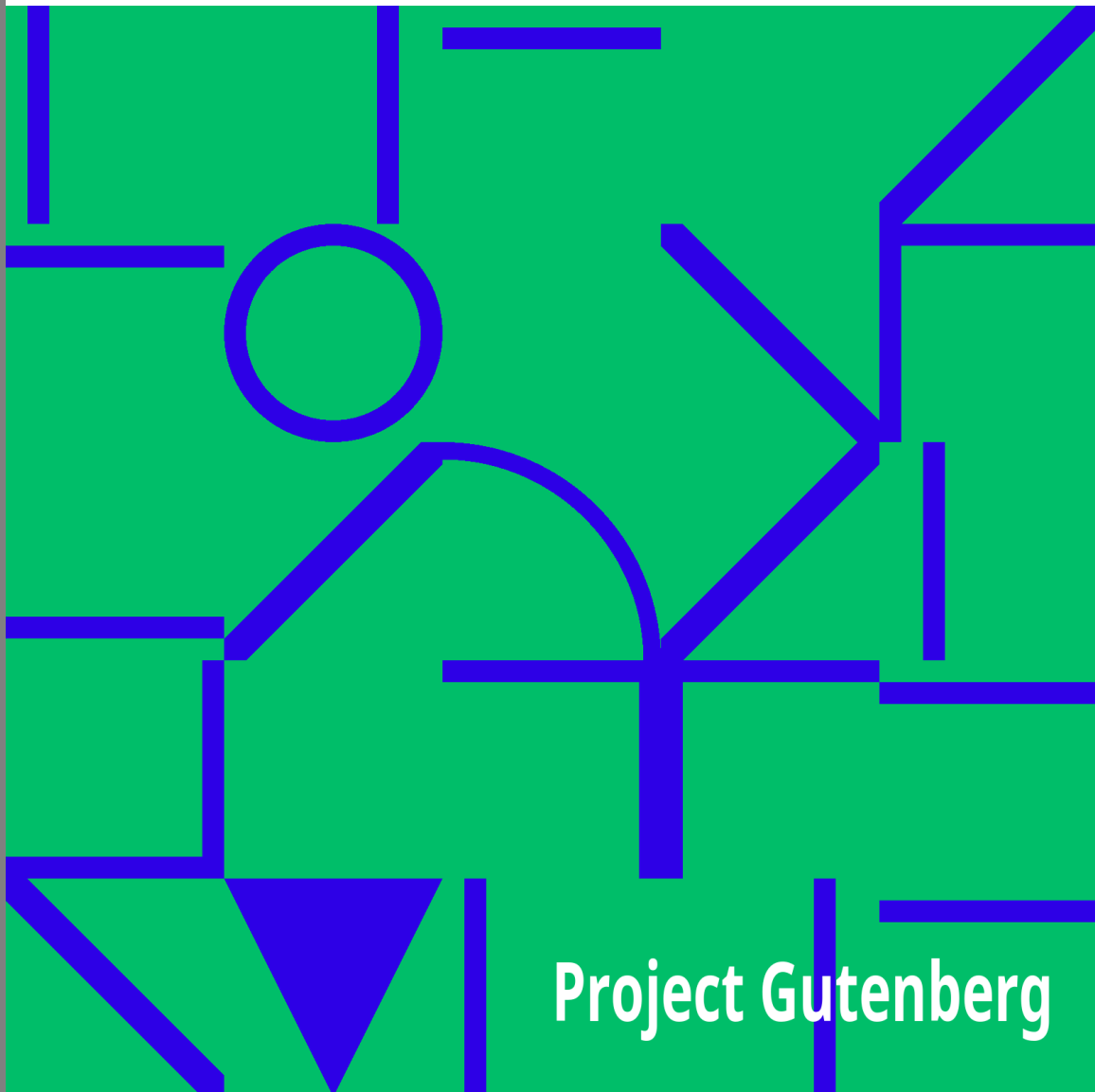
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The New Morning: Poems

Alfred Noyes



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THE NEW MORNING

ALFRED NOYES

WORKS OF ALFRED NOYES

COLLECTED POEMS—2 *Vols.*

THE LORD OF MISRULE

A BELGIAN CHRISTMAS EVE

THE WINE-PRESS

WALKING SHADOWS—*Prose*

TALES OF THE MERMAID TAVERN

SHERWOOD

THE ENCHANTED ISLAND AND OTHER POEMS

DRAKE: AN ENGLISH EPIC

POEMS

THE FLOWER OF OLD JAPAN

THE GOLDEN HYNDE

THE NEW MORNING

THE NEW MORNING

POEMS

BY

ALFRED NOYES



NEW YORK
FREDERICK A. STOKES COMPANY
PUBLISHERS

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DEDICATION

TO THE MEMORY OF SIR CECIL SPRING-RICE

I.

Not as any soldier of the line

He served his England, with the imminent death
in heart. Nor could the world divine

The constant peril of each burdened breath.

For the honour of England, he still served

Walking the strict path, with the old high pride
of noble knights who never swerved

One hair's breadth from the way until they died.

He loved, and books, and the grave beauty

Of England's Helicon, whose eternal light
shined on that road of duty,

Discerned by few in this chaotic night.

When, foretelling his release,

He foreknew "the end was peace."

II.

land, he shall live unsleeping

Among his friends, with the old proud flag above;
y her honour is in his keeping.

He has joined the hosts that guard her with their love.

e stars, unnumbered happy legions,

In that high realm where all our darkness dies.
th honour, in those loftier regions,
orld of passion and of lies":

ed it, keeping his own pure passion

A silent flame before the true and good;
n the throng in this world's fashion
what all might see who would.

land, brave and gentle knight,
dney welcomes you tonight.

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THE NEW MORNING

"THE AVENUE OF THE ALLIES"

song of the wind as it came
flags of the nations to flame:

*I am the breath of God. I am His laughter.
Trinity. That is my name.*

land, at night, on the city.
giving beauty and pity,
proudest street of the world
the banners that earth has unfurled;
stars that are brighter than stars.
led on its way to the wars,
America, sweeping along
triumph like notes in a song,
gentle as man to his mate,
land when he moved to create,—

Never was voice of a nation so glorious,
rise and afire with its fate!
led on mightier pinion
height of a brighter dominion,
hope of the prophets to flame,
from the deep as it came,

Cleave me a way for an army with banners.

ty. *That is my name.*

meaning of all they are doing?
light that their soul is pursuing?
might of the world they are making,
nations whose heart is awaking?
mingling of peoples and races?
order and joy in their faces!
folds of the union are spreading!
nations are come to their wedding.
folk of our tongue be afraid of it?
born of it. England was made of it,
melding of tribes into one,
of pilgrims that followed the sun!
man and Saxon were drawn
his Pentecost, out of the dawn,
make her one people of many;
union more mighty than any.
soul of this deep exultation?
word that goes forth to this nation?

I am the breath of God. I am His Liberty.
ught over all His creation.

continent, wholly united,
the foemen in Europe are plighted.
sue that our blindness and pride
louted and mocked and denied,
public, the laughing, gigantic

l, beyond the Atlantic.
ca, speaking one tongue,
cs before they are sung,
ils from the palms to the snow,
s that are greater than Emperors know,
ates that are empires in might,
he will of one people tonight,
body, with net-works of steel,
strength in the one Commonweal,
overty, mocking at Mars,
cities to talk with the stars.
easing by myriads again
umbers old Europe may wane.
on of the England they fought
the full pride of his thought,
scoffers who, year after year,
ublic their half-hidden sneer?
auty she stands at our side,
hhold the full gift of his pride?
England who knows that her son,
ought her, and Liberty won.
se names like the stars in their station,
ot of that world's Declaration,—
ivingston, Langdon, she claims them,
o be proud when she names them,
voice in the night as it came,
igs of the nations to flame:

*I am the breath of God. I am His laughter.
ty. That is my name.*

selves, are but rags that are dyed.
wind, are like nations enskied.
grapple the night as it rolls
t under like triumphing souls.
hat never knew sleep,
otous folds as they leap.
tri-colors, laughing for France,
isper and thunder and dance;
flags for Great Britain aflame
sisters in Liberty's name.
rning in pride overhead.
, and her sunrise is red.
er, and fluttering between,
in red, white, and green.
climb like adventurous flowers,
of the terrible towers....
larkness, the glories are mated.
larkness, a world is created.
Pentecost, streaming on high.
glory of stars in the sky.
id flag of our union and liberty
id night-wind and tyrannies die.

ON THE WESTERN FRONT

(1916)

I.

lreadful acre of the dead,
 Marked with the only sign on earth that saves.
death were hurrying overhead,
 The loose earth shook on those unquiet graves;

un-pits, with quick stabs of flame,
 Made their own thunders of the sunlit air;
he crosses, name by name,
 Mort pour la France, it seemed that peace was there;
eace, a peace too deep for thought,
 The peace of tides that underlie our strife,
h which the moving heavens are fraught,
 The peace that is our everlasting life.

h shook. The very hills were stirred.
the dead was all I heard.

II.

e here, have nothing more to pray.

To all your praises we are deaf and blind.
ven know if you betray
Our hope, to make earth better for mankind.

ce, in the night, shall grow

More silent, as the stars grow in the sky;
u deck our graves, you shall not know
How many scornful legions pass you by.

heard you say (when we were living)

That some small dream of good would "cost too much."
foe struck, we have watched you giving,
And seen you move the mountains with one touch.

lone, we know. But, have no fear!

v, we shall not see or hear.

VICTORY

(Written after the British Service at Trinity Church, New York)

I.

ose golden altar-lights we stood,
Each one of us remembering his own dead.
arthly beauty seemed to brood
On that hushed throng, and bless each bending head.

nat gold, the deep-sea blue
Of those young seamen, ranked on either side,
khaki, while the silence grew
Deep, as for wings—Oh, deep as England's pride.

nat gold, two banners rose—
Two flags that told how Freedom's realm was made,
stars of hope, and one that shows
The glorious cross of England's long crusade;

w joined, till that high will be done
em forth to make the whole world one.

II.

o signs of joy that eyes could see.

Our hearts were all three thousand miles away.

o trumpets blown for victory.

A million dead were calling us that day.

v blind, at times; but grief was deep,

Deeper than any foes or friends have known;

untry's lips are locked to keep

Her bitterest loss her own, and all her own.

c told what else was dumb,

The funeral march to which our pulses beat;

id went by, to a muffled drum

We heard the tread of all those phantom feet.

s victory! Deep in every soul.

n marching to their unseen goal.

III.

gain, we saw the Cross go by,

The Cross that fell with all those glorious towers,

. France or mocked on Calvary,

Till—in one night—the crosses rose like flowers,

all white crosses, mile on mile,

Pencilled with names that had outfought all pain,

hell-torn acre seems to smile—

Who shall destroy the cross that rose again?

world's Walpurgis, where hope perished,
Where all the forms of faith in ruin fell,
Sign of heaven that earth had cherished
Shrivelled among the lava-floods of hell,

Cross that conquers might with right
To lead us through the night.

IV.

World remember? Men forget:
Our dead are all too many even for Fame!
Kneels to kings, and pays no debt
To those who never courted her acclaim.

Heart with promises to pay
For gifts beyond all price so freely given.
Heart so rich that it can say
To those who mourn, "I will restore your heaven"?

With their own hands, laid up their treasure
Where never an emperor can break in and steal,
Those that loved them past all measure
In those high griefs that earth can never heal,

That walk on earth, yet gaze above,
Sorrow is but remembered love.

V.

holds us with immortal power,
 Yet cannot lift us to His realm of light;
shows us heaven for one brief hour
 Only to daunt the heart with that sheer height;

ade of loveliness entire
 In form and thought and act; and still must shame us
er acknowledge and aspire,
 And yet let slip the shining hands that claim us.

e might cloak with rags His glory,
l drink, and dwell with suffering men,
our hearth, and hear our story,
 This world—we thought—might be transfigured then.

re answered, with swift human tears,
igs have I done, these many years."

VI.

ve said, "if ye will hear my voice;
 I mount and sing with birds in all your skies.
hat calls you to rejoice.
 And every wayside flower is my disguise.

Are the wings too wide for pity?

Look closely. Do these tender hues betray?

Ye I sought my Holy City?

How often have ye turned your hearts away?

Dealing in the beauty I bring you?

Am I not whispering in green leaves and rain,
That woods and seas can sing you?

Look, once, on Love, and earth is heaven again.

Spring but once a century waken,

Heavens for this would be forsaken."

VII.

The gift that all our dead desire,

One gift that men can give, and that's a dream,

Can burn with that same fire

Of sacrifice; die to the things that seem;

The hatreds; die to greed;

Die to the old ignoble selves we knew;

The contempts of sect and creed,

And rise again, like these, with souls as true.

(These died before their task was finished)

Attempt new heights, bring even their dreams to birth:—

Better world, Oh, not diminished

By one true splendor that they planned on earth.

done by sword, or tongue, or pen,
e way. God make us better men.

AMERICAN POEMS 1912–1917

REPUBLIC AND MOTHERLAND

(1912)

(Written after entering New York Harbor at Daybreak)

harbor with the morning sun
The ship swept in from sea;
rs arose, the night was done,
And—there stood Liberty.

at torch lifted in one hand,
The dawn in her proud eyes,
he shouts that vex her land,
Silent, hailing the skies;

ightier Kingdom of the Blest
Our seamen sought of old,
it lured the nations through the West,
The city of sunset gold.

rman in one wedded soul
Shook out one flag like fire;
, westward, moved the gleaming goal,
Westward, the vast desire.

ever westward ran the call,

They followed the pilgrim sun,
and which should enfold them all,
And weld all hearts in one.

lighter continent apart,
Here on these rolling plains,
The throb of that immortal heart,
The pulse of those huge veins.

owers, our Old-World cities jest,
And neither hear nor see
gods at that gigantic breast,
The conquering race to be.

nany—for no sluggard soul
Confronts that night of stars—
of the last Republic roll
Far off, an end to wars;

d to that wild blood-red age,
That made and keeps us blind;
ilm shall be her heritage,
The kingdom of mankind.

nany nations, and made one;
But first, O Mother, from thee,
ing, following on that Pilgrim sun,
Thy Mayflower crossed the sea.

THE UNION

(1917)

Have gathered together the sons of all races,
And welded them into one,
Each of your Freedom on hungering faces
That sailed to the setting sun;

Made of mankind in your own proud regions
The music of man to be,
The old earth sing of you, now, as your legions
Rise to set all men free?

The singer that knew the proud vision and loved it,
In the days when not all men knew,
His tears, on the light, now the world has approved it;
Or dream, when the dream comes true?

We sing when the Spirit of Freedom in thunder
Speaks, and the wine-press is red;
Hinds are loud with the chains that are broken asunder
And nations that rise from the dead?

O, proud flag of that wide communion,
Too mighty for thought to scan;

my in one, and that last world-union
That kingdom of God in man;

eam, in the night, of that last federation,
But yours is the glory unfurled—
d nations and stars that shall make one nation
One singing star of the world.

GHOSTS OF THE NEW WORLD

"There are no ghosts in America."

no ghosts, you say,
 To haunt her blaze of light;
n her day,
 No phantoms in her night.
tered sail
yond our hail.

t magic coast,
 Where Raleigh fought with fate,
Devon ghost
 Unbarred the Golden Gate,
ge, ear-ringed men
ea again?

alem town
 With silver buckled shoon?
ch to drown
 Or burn beneath the moon?
iff of tea,
limmering quay.

anish walls,
 Where brown Franciscans glide,

ce that calls

Across the Great Divide,

in their way

to the Fe?

Pullman cars

Go roaring to the West,

by lonelier stars,

The cactus lifts its crest.

Painted plain,

I rise again.

Forlorn,

Wreck of a dying race,

Half in scorn,

Shall raise his haughty face,

the sky,

ghosts go by.

Am I dreaming still?

Shall not the night disgorge

Bunker Hill

The ghosts of Valley Forge,

mightiest son,

Washington?

Where Lincoln fell?

No ghosts for seeing eyes?

Cracked bell

Shall make ten million rise
nortal ghost
umbering host.



THE OLD MEETING HOUSE

(New Jersey, 1918)

ves were made for peace till Gabriel blows his horn.

Those wise old elms could hear no cry

Of all that distant agony—

vinged blackbird, and the rustle of thick ripe corn.

erched upon that bronze, with bright unweeting eyes,

Could never read the names that signed

The noblest charter of mankind;

n were names we knew beneath our English skies.

w gray headstones, with their crumbling weather-stains,

—Though cardinal birds, like drops of blood,

Flickered across the haunted wood,—

u'd see were names that woke like flowers in English lanes.

e was fast asleep; and Temperance Olden, too.

And David Worth had quite forgot

If Hannah's lips were red or not;

veiled her eyes at last, as Prudence ought to do.

ross that patch of heaven, that small blue leaf-edged space

At times, a droning airplane went,

No flicker of astonishment
heavy eyelids on one gossip's up-turned face.

peakman could not tell—so thick the grasses grow—
If that strange humming in the sky
Meant that the Judgment Day were nigh,
the summer bees that blundered to and fro.

oss the breathless wood, a Bell began to sound,
The only Bell that wakes the dead,
And Stockton Signer raised his head,
all the deacons in the ancient burial-ground.

Bell is ringing! Give me back my rusty sword.
Though I thought the wars were done,
Though I thought our peace was won,
ie Declaration, and the dead must keep their word.

one great ghost I know could make that 'larum ring.
It's the captain that we knew
In the ancient buff and blue,
hman, George Washington, who fought the German king!"

saw them mustering beneath their brooding boughs,
Ancient shadows of our sires,
Kindling with the ancient fires,
cracked Bell to southward shook the ancient meeting house.

PRINCETON

(1917)

The first four lines of this poem were written for inscription on the first joint memorial to the American and British soldiers who fell in the Revolutionary War. This memorial was recently dedicated at Princeton.

I.

*dom stood, by slaughtered friend and foe,
And ere the wrath paled or that sunset died,
In the ages: then, with eyes aglow,
Laid them, to wait that future, side by side.*

II.

gardens in the blue dusk shine
Through dog-wood red and white,
Gray quadrangles, line by line,
The windows fill with light,
On calls to Magdalen, tower to tower,
Twin lanthorns of the law,
Am-white magnolia boughs embower
The halls of old Nassau.

III.

ze tigers crouch on either side
Where red-coats used to pass,
: bird-loved house where Mercer died
And violets dusk the grass,
ok that ran so red of old,
But sings of friendship now,
d enemy's harvest fifty-fold
The green earth takes the plough.

IV.

May night if one great ghost should stray
With deep remembering eyes,
l meadow of battle smiles away
Its blood-stained memories,
should walk, where friend and foe
Sleep and forget the past,
quenched heart would leap to know
Their hosts are joined at last.

V.

lks, in shadowy buff and blue,
Where those dim lilacs wave,
read to bless, as dreams come true,
The promise of that grave,

aster hope than thought can scan,
 Touching his ancient sword,
mightier realm of God in man,
 "Hasten Thy Kingdom, Lord."

VI.

hope, land of the singing stars,
 Type of the world to be,
a world set free from wars
 Takes life, takes form, from thee,
jarring nations of this earth,
 Beneath the all-blessing sun,
music of mankind to birth,
 And make the whole world one."

VII.

comrades rise around him there,
 Old foemen, side by side,
stars upon the brave night-air,
 And young as when they died,
bells, O beautiful Princeton towers,
 Ring for the world's release.
piercing like gray swords through flowers,
 And smile from hearts at peace.

BEETHOVEN IN CENTRAL PARK

(After a glimpse of a certain monument in New York, during the Victory Celebration)

and-windowed towers were all alight.

Thronged of all nations filled that glittering way;
In dreams of the approaching day,
Tyrannies trampled down the night.
Sunset, die in airs as bright.

No clouds, at dawn, awake in winds as gay;
For Freedom rose in that august array,
The stars and weaponed for the right.

Sea of whispering leaves and gloom,

I saw, too dark, too dumb for bronze or stone,
One tragic head that bowed against the sky;
Too deep for any tomb

I saw Beethoven, dreadfully alone
With his own grief, and his own majesty.

SONGS OF THE TRAWLERS AND SEA POEMS

THE PEOPLE'S FLEET

darkened fishing-ports they go,
A fleet of little ships, whose every name—
lark, Rose and Surf and Snow,
Burns in this blackness like an altar-flame;

t they sail, three thousand strong,
The people's fleet that never knew its worth,
ne is a broken phrase of song
To some remembered loveliness on earth.

ra Cowie, Comely Bank and May,
Christened, at home, in worlds of dawn and dew:
nd *Kindly Light and Robin Gray*
With *Mizpah*. (May that simple prayer come true!)

gland's inmost heart they sail,
A fleet of memories that can never fail.

KILMENY

lay the drifters against the red West,
As they shot their long meshes of steel overside;
green waters were rocking to rest
When Kilmeny went out, at the turn of the tide;
new where that lassie would roam,
For the magic that called her was tapping unseen.
gh a week ere Kilmeny came home,
And nobody knew where Kilmeny had been.

her bow that was Newcastle's best,
And a gun at her stern that was fresh from the Clyde,
er skipper had never confessed,
Not even at dawn, to his newly-wed bride;
s that whispered above, like a gnome,
The laughter of London, the boasts of Berlin....
e been mermaids that lured her from home;
new where Kilmeny had been.

nen Kilmeny came home from her quest
With her bridge dabbled red where her skipper had died;
d like a bride with a rose at her breast,
And *Well done Kilmeny!* the Admiral cried.

four fathom a conger may come

And nose at the bones of a drowned submarine;
In the evening Kilmeny came home,
And nobody knew where Kilmeny had been.

dering shadow that stares at the foam,
Though they sing all the night to old England, their queen.
In the evening, Kilmeny came home;
And nobody knew where Kilmeny had been.

CAP'N STORM-ALONG

uffeting out in the bitter grey weather,
 Blow the man down, bullies, blow the man down!
ng to *Golden Feather*,
 And burly blue waters all swelling aroun'.
'erstone butting ahead as they wallow,
 With death in the mesh of their deep-sea trawl;
Hawk swooping by wild *Sea-swallow*;
 And old Cap'n Storm-along leading 'em all.

*Bashing the seas to a welter of white,
Look at the fleet that he leads to the fight.
O, they're dancing like witches to open the ball;
And old Cap'n Storm-along's lord of 'em all.*

ave you seen such a bully old sailor?
 His eyes are as blue as the scarf at his throat;
n the bridge of his broad-beamed whaler,
 In yellow sou'wester and oil-skin coat.
drifter, in dinghy and dory,
 Wherever he signals, they leap to his call;
e seas to a lather of glory,
 With old Cap'n Storm-along leading 'em all.

You'll find he's from Devon, the sailor I mean,

*Look at his whaler now, shipping it green.
O, Fritz and his "U" boat must crab it and crawl
When old Cap'n Storm-along sails to the ball.*

a skipper that knows how to scare 'em.

Blow the man down, bullies, blow the man down!

a-wives he keeps in his harem,

Wicked young merry-maids, buxom and brown:
nd, the sea-witch, and *Gipsy* so lissom,

All dancing like ducks in the teeth of the squall,
eye for Huns, and a Hotchkiss to kiss 'em;

For old Cap'n Storm-along's lord of 'em all.

*Look at him, battering darkness to light!
Look at the fleet that he leads to the fight!
O, hearts that are mighty, in ships that are small,
Your old Cap'n Storm-along's lord of us all.*

THE BIG BLACK TRAWLER

best ship that ever I knew,
—Ah-way O, to me O—
black trawler with a deep-sea crew—
Sing, my bullies, let the bullgine run.

old devil with a broken nose
—Ah-way O, to me O—
core years, as I suppose—
But, sing, my bullies, let the bullgine run.

ed last March, in a Polar storm
—Ah-way O, to me O—
the old cripple if his feet was warm—
Sing, my bullies, let the bullgine run.

ld devil (he was ninety at the most)
—Ah-way O, to me O—
arm as a lickle piece of toast"—
So sing, my bullies, let the bullgine run.

my sea-boots and my dungarees
—Ah-way O, to me O—
It water that the Lord don't freeze"—

Oh, sing, my bullies, let the bullgine run.



NAMESAKES

s the brown drifter that went out alone?

—*Roll and go, and fare you well—*

Peggy Nutten? That name is my own.

Fare you well, my sailor.

he dark, "Let her go! Let her go!"

l to the West, where the broad waters flow;

s come back, but ... the bitter winds blow.

Ah, fare you well, my sailor.

t evening, they wave and they cheer.

—*Roll and go, and fare you well—*

g to welcome their lads at the pier.

Fare you well, my sailor.

ning home in the twilight below;

e little boat.... Let her go! Let her go!

y heart, and a heart for the foe.

Ah, fare you well, my sailor.

he Maggie, the Ruth and the Joan,

—*Roll and go, and fare you well—*

their namesakes, and leave me alone.

Fare you well, my sailor.

e kep' dark, for the spies mustn't know;

k in my face, an' I think it will show;

s my name. Let her go! let her go!

Ah, fare you well, my sailor.



WIRELESS

se who search the deep,
 Gleam of Hope and Kindly Light,
ou turn to sleep,
 Breathe a message through the night.
at they'll receive it.
and you'll believe it.

urn against the stars,
 Decks where death is wallowing green,
th among their spars,
 Hear the flickering threads between,
h all the storms that blind them,
ords that rush to find them.

se aërial wires
 Whisper more than spirits may?
t our strong desires
 Touch no distance when we pray?
t no wings are flying
ng and the dying?

pon your knees,
 You shall breathe from urgent lips,
ps that guard your seas,

Fleet on fleet of angel ships;
led may so bless them
s can distress them.

le the darkling prow,
Kneeling thus—and far inland—
h the storm-beat brow
Gently as a spirit-hand.
old prayer may speed them,
ild may lead them.

FISHERS OF MEN

ago He said,
wake the dead,
And walk upon the sea—
"Come, follow Me.

rown nets and bring
rts to sing,
Only your souls to pray,
Rise, come away.

ur spirit-sails,
se wilder gales,
And I will make you then
Fishers of men."

, what He meant?
igh intent,
After two thousand years
Of blood and tears?

f we fight
not for might.
God help us if we seek

To shield the weak.

His heaven be far

d welter of war,

He'll bless us, on the sea

From Calvary.



AN OPEN BOAT

that whimpering there in the darkness?

*"Let him lie in my arms. He is breathing, I know.
I'll wrap all my hair round his neck."—"The sea's rising,
The boat must be lightened. He's dead. He must go."*

by that flash, where the bitter foam tosses,
The cloud of white faces, in the black open boat,
The pleading woman that clasps her dead lover
And wraps her loose hair round his breast and his throat.

*He's dead." "No, I feel his heart beating.
He's living, I know. But he's numbed with the cold.
I'll wrap my hair all around him to warm him"—
—"No. We can't keep the dead, dear. Come, loosen your hold.*

*n your fingers."—"O God, let me keep him!"
O, hide it, black night! Let the winds have their way!
No voices or ghosts from that darkness,
To fret the bare seas at the breaking of day.*

PEACE IN A PALACE

weeping in the night," said the Emperor,

"Weeping in your sleep, I am told."

g but a dream," said the Empress;

But her face grew gray and old.

you saw our German God defeated?"

"Oh, no!" she said. "I saw no lightnings fall.

! whirlpool of green water,

Where something had gone down. That was all.

himper of the sea gulls flying,

Endlessly round and round,

2 faces, the faces from the darkness,

The dreadful rising faces of the drowned.

g but a dream," said the Empress.

"I thought I was walking on the sea;

rushed up in a wild smother,

And a crowd of little faces looked at me.

owning! They were drowning," said the Empress,

"And they stretched their feeble arms to the sky;

was—they mistook me for their mother,

And cried as my children used to cry.

1 whimper of the sea-gulls flying,
Endlessly round and round,
yellow beaks that were waiting for the faces,
The little floating faces of the drowned."

g but a dream," said the Emperor,
"So why should you weep, dear, eh?"—
red letters on a life belt
That the green sea washed my way!"—
ey?" said the Emperor. "What were they?"—
"Some of them were hidden," said the Empress,
"But I plainly saw the L and the U!"
e, stop!" said the Emperor.
"You told me that it was not true!

you dreamed of the sea gulls flying,
Endlessly round and round,
2 faces, and the eyes in the faces,
The eyes of the children that we drowned.

forget it," said the Emperor,
"Dry your tears on the tassel of my sword.
offer peace to my people,
And abdicate, perhaps, as overlord.
ce up My Cross as Count of Prussia—
Which is not a heavy burden, you'll agree.
re twenty million dead are rotten
There'll be yachting days again for you and me.
Cheer up!

l a rope for anyone but Me."

!" said the Empress. "They are flying,
 Endlessly round and round.
shed with the faces, the dreadful little faces,
 The little eyeless faces of the drowned."

THE VINDICTIVE

And we praise those lads of the old *Vindictive*

Who looked Death straight in the eyes,
Still his gaze fell,
At those red gates of hell?

Her proud history, proudly enrolls them,

And the deep night in her remembering skies
With purer glory
Shall blazon their grim story.

Her throngs to applaud that hushed adventure.

They were one to a thousand on that fierce emprise.
The shores they sought
Were armoured, past all thought.

Fear, be assured, as the brave must know it,

With youth and its happiness bidding their last good-byes;
Still thoughts, more dear
Than life, cast out all fear.

For if, as we think, they remembered the brown-roofed homesteads,
Of the hawthorn hedges when daylight dies,
Old happy places,

young eyes and fading faces;

is dearer that night than the best of their boyhood,

One hope more radiant than any their hearts could prize.

the touch of your hand,

the light of your face, England!

shall tell how they sailed through the darkness

Where, under those high, austere, implacable stars,

not one in ten

might look for a dawn again.

ferry-boats, *Iris* and *Daffodil*, creeping

Darkly as clouds to the shimmering mine-strewn bars,

dash into light!

When thunder reddened the night.

The swords of the search-lights blinded and stabbed them,

The sharp black shadows fought in fantastic wars.

Black waves leapt whitening,

Red decks were washed with lightning.

twelve-inch guns of the black land-batteries

The hacked bright hulk, in a glory of crackling spars,

Loved to her goal

Like an immortal soul;

Her raw rent flesh in a furnace is tortured,

Reigns by a law no agony ever can shake,
and shines in power
above all shocks of the hour.

As the decks ran blood, and the star-shells lightened
The old broken ship that the enemy never could break,
wept through the fire
and grappled her heart's desire.

reck that blazed with the soul of England,
The lads that died in the dark for England's sake
new, as they died,
elton was at their side;

l the ghostly fleets of his island,
Fighting beside them there, and the soul of Drake!—
reams, as we knew,
ill these lads made them true.

*e praise you, lads of the old Vindictive,
Who looked death straight in the eyes,
ill his gaze fell
i those red gates of hell?*

MISCELLANEOUS POEMS

THE CHIMNEY-SWEEPS OF CHELTENHAM

Thorn buds are creaming white,
And the red foolscap all stuck with may,
All with eyes alight,
And it's chimney-sweepers' dancing day.

Chimney-sweeps of Cheltenham town,
Sooty of face as a swallow of wing,
Sing, singing, dancing down
With white teeth flashing as they sing.

One green, by a clown in blue,
Walks like a two-legged bush of may,
Wee lads that wriggled up the flue
Ere Cheltenham town cried "dancing day."

Here short and the chimneys tall,
And the gipsies caught 'em these blackbirds cheap,
He bought them, spry and small,
And shoved them up in the dark to sweep.

Her mother was cruel of old,
But she has been gathering garlands gay,
Wee lads are in green and gold,

For it's chimney-sweepers' dancing day.

ose, and blue as the sky,

With teeth as white as their faces are black,
sweeps go dancing by,

With a gridiron painted on every back.

are ranged in the market-place,

The clown's wife comes with an iron spoon,
penny for her sweet face

To keep their golden throats in tune.

the riot of that mad throng,

And sweet as the voice of a long-dead May,
pedlar lifts 'em a song,

Of chimney-sweepers' dancing day;

faces, they try to recall....

As they gather around in their spell-struck rings....
rows that singer at all

Or the curious old-time air he sings:—

dancing, O chimney-sweeps of Cheltenham,

And where did you win you these may-coats so fine;
red as roses, and some are gold as daffodils,

But who, ah, who remembers, now, a little lad of mine?

dancing, as we danced in old England

When the May was more than May, very long ago:
May-coats, it was your white hands, lady,
Filled our sooty hearts and minds with blossom, white as snow.

Beautiful face we saw, wandering through Cheltenham.
It was a beautiful song we heard, very far away,
Little lad stolen by the gipsies,
Broke our hearts and filled 'em with the glory of the May.

And had we, chirruping in the chimney-tops,
Twirling out a sooty broom, a blot against the blue.
We called to him, and when he saw and ran to her,
All our winter ended, and our world was made anew.

For us May-coats of gold and green and crimson,
Then, with a long garland, she led our hearts away,
Remember, though the boughs forget the hawthorn,
Yet shall I return to you, that was your lady May."—

You dancing now, O chimney-sweeps of Cheltenham,
And why are you singing of a May that is fled?—
Fled to be born, though we pluck the old fiddle-strings,
And a world's May awaking where the fields lay dead.

So, dance, dreaming of a lady most beautiful
That shall walk the green valleys of this dark earth one day,
Gently, "O chimney-sweeps of Cheltenham,
I am looking for my children. Awake, and come away."

TO A SUCCESSFUL MAN

(What the Ghosts Said)

all the labour and the pains,

After the heaping up of gold on gold,
that locked your feet in chains,

And left you with a heart so tired and old,

not?—to find your chief desire

Is what you might have had for nothing then—
ve beside a cottage fire

And friendly laughter with your fellow-men?

ich when fools esteemed you poor.

You ruled a field that kings could never buy;
he sea was at your door;

And all those quiet stars were in your sky.

erns below the breathless wood

Where one poor book could unlock Paradise ...
give us now for that lost good?

Better forget. You cannot pay the price.

for the fame in which you trust.

But youth, and hope—did you forsake them, too?

en dust at length returns to dust,
eams they may come back to you.



THE OLD GENTLEMAN WITH THE AMBER SNUFF-BOX

tleman, tapping his amber snuff-box
ed snuff-box with a golden clasp)
lying fire. "I'd like them all
, when I am gone," he muttered.
o it delicately! I can't
hint at it ... in verse;
e that Rosalind reads it through,
appendix to my will!"
, you see. He couldn't help it.
much, felt much. He snapped the snuff box,
te periwig, trimmed a long quill pen,
in to write, most carefully,
s, in the old heroic style:—

n in boyhood, only known
uths that time has made my own,
he best that youth can give,
, in learning how to live.
heart would not be tired so soon,
od would jog to a livelier tune:
r friends, could I begin again,
more happiness, and much less pain.
ound in ignorance, nor turn

e from those for whom I yearn.
kept nigh half the friends I've lost,
learest those I wronged the most.

e more cunning men evade
ct, the blunders that I made;
vonder if the better part
ie, who lacked their subtle art.
ined my book in harsher schools,
rom struggling what they worked by rules;
h some pain—more quickly to forgive
nderers, while they learn to live;
h some tears—to keep a steadfast mind,
re kindly of my own poor kind.

*urses through, shaking his wig.
perhaps"—he whispered to himself,
ve it to the will of God.
set my own. I do not think
tand. Jocelyn might, perhaps;
nly they were left alone.
never; nor that nephew of mine,
ician. No. No. No.
mind was wandering, I'm afraid."
en face, reluctantly,
verses into the dying fire,
he sparks fly upward.
There, at dawn,
n, cold and stiff by the cold hearth,
tiff-box in his ivory hand.*

y said, "he never needed friends.
rious antique frozen way.
irt—only an amber snuff-box.
happily, taking a pinch of snuff."

at engaging politician,
nuff-box, and remarked
ould be "Snuffed Out." The clubs
the statesman's reputation grew.

WHAT GRANDFATHER SAID

(An epistle from a narrow-minded old gentleman to a young artist of superior intellect and intense realism.)

ghts are for the poor and weak?

Ah, no, the picturesque's your passion!

is always in your cheek

At poverty that's not in fashion.

ughman's rugged face,

Or painted eyes in Piccadilly;

ts are commonplace,

And thread-bare tradesmen simply silly.

sings "God save the King,"

And still believes his Tory paper,—

næmic fool? I thought

You loved the weak! Was that all vapour?

sneer, dear democrat,

At such a shiny-trouser'd Tory

ffs his poor old hat

To what he thinks his country's glory,

t a coloured rag.

You hate the "patriots" that bawl so.

ses, there's a flag
That lifts men in Republics also.

houghts are cruder far;
And, where those linen folds are shaking,
es a kind of star
Because his eyes are tired and aching.

! Banal as truth!
But I'm not thinking of his banners.
f his pinched white youth
And your disgusting "new art" manners.

nission stirs your hate?
Better, my lad, if you're so fervent,
l steel against the State
Instead of sneering at the servant.

b. He draws his pay.
You sneer, and dine with those that pay him;
write a snobbish play
For democrats, in which you play him.

ike simplicity
That sucks its cheeks to make the dimple.
stic bourgeoisie
You hate,—because it's all too simple.

earth, the wife, the child,
 You hate the heavens that bend above them.
folk must all run wild
 Like jungle-beasts before you love them.

use in Cheyne Walk,
 (You say it costs three thousand fully)
snobs can talk and talk
 And play the intellectual bully.

obs." Are names alone
 Free from all change? Your word "Victorian"
I sting in ninety one
 But now—it's deadlier than the saurian.

re in yesterday,
 Because I think your way the wrong one;
ved and ploughed my way,
 And—unlike yours—it's been a long one.

oll her bell,
 And went with Strindberg for a ride, sir.
ough your own day as well,
 And come out on the other side, sir,—

le, the morning side,
 I read free verse (the Psalms) on Sunday.
ed (you'll decide)

That there is room for song on Monday.

ew snob on his way,

The intellectual snob I mean, sir,

o, in book and play,

Kicking his mother round the scene, sir.

Tories talk like fools;

And the rich fool that apes the Tory.

hopmen break your rules

And die like Christ, in Christ's own glory.

l, that liberal sneer

Reminds me of the poor old Kaiser.

ialist," my dear.

Well, I'm your grandson. You'll grow wiser.

MEMORIES OF THE PACIFIC COAST

and, I, too,

Where warm keen incense on the sea-wind blows,
nearer long the skies are blue,
And the brown deserts blossom with the rose.

delight,

Cactus and palm and earth of thirsty gold,
gleams round eaves of sun-washed white,
And that Hesperian fruit men sought of old.

dwelling there,

Under the palm-trees, on that sunset shore,
voices break in song, and the bright air
Is crystal clean; and peace is ours, once more.

dwells,

Beauty, re-born in whiteness from the foam;
gleams with all its magic spells,
And the heart finds its long-forgotten home,—

! Where is that land?

For, when I dream it found, the old hungering cry
howls, drives me from all I planned,

And sets my sail to seek another sky.



NIPPON

I dreamed of Nippon....

I saw a cloud of white
e the sunset
On seas of opal light.

ide Pacific

I saw its mounded snow
changing
In that deep evening glow,

nd hillocks,

To orchards that I knew,
each and cherry,
And feathers of bamboo.

ed bridges,

In blue and crimson gleams,
f the fishers,
Along the brook of dreams.

ths of incense

Like little ghosts arise,
under Fuji,

From Fuji to the skies.

y mountain....

I watched it form and fade.

gods were singing,

When Nippon isle was made.



THE HUMMING BIRDS

ing and ruby throat,
What shining spell, what exquisite sorcery,
'loat
And fight with bees round this one flowering tree?

of light,
What whisper or gleam or elfin-wild perfumes
gh the night
And drew you to this hive of rosy bloom?

one alone,
Of all that load this magic air with spice,
own
Your brave migration out of Paradise;

nd guides you, too,
Three thousand miles across the summer's waste
knew
Less finely fit for your ethereal taste.

hful hearts,
Even so the quivering April thoughts will fly,—
arts,

Those winged and tiny denizens of the sky.

s as needle-fine,

They suck a redder honey than bees know.

e

Sleeps in this bloom; and, when it falls, they go.



LINES FOR A SUN-DIAL

owly pen I write,
ill time be done,
 Good news of some strange light,
un.



THE REALMS OF GOLD

(Written after hearing a line of Keats repeated by a passing stranger under the palms of Southern California.)

palms of San Diego

Where gold-skinned Mexicans loll at ease,
alf-moons of their black-pipped melons
Drop from their hands in the sunset seas,
e, out of the old brown missions,
Blows through the orange trees;

a poet who died in Europe

Had found his way to this rose-red West;
d walked by the wide Pacific
And cradled his head on its healing breast,
v songs of the sun-burned sea-folk,
New poems, perhaps his best.

m, under the ripe pomegranates

At the desert's edge, where the grape-vines grow,
d ranch between grey-green sage-brush
And amethyst mountains, peaked with snow,
ae lights of the City of Angels
Glitter like stars below.

k, at dawn, by the lemon orchards,

And breathe at ease in that dry bright air;

sh bells in their crumbling cloisters
Of brown adobe would sing to him there;
ranciscans would bring him their baskets
Of apple and olive and pear.

olins, in the deep blue twilight,
Under that palm with the lion's mane,
once more, at his golden heart-strings,
And tell him the old sea-tales of Spain;
uld the daughters of Hesperus teach him
Their mystical songs again.

blew sweet over seas of peach-bloom;
The moon sailed white in the cloudless blue;
purred, and the crickets chirruped;
n anything dreamed came true;
murmuring palms, a shadow
Passed, with the eyes I knew;

haps, of the tall green fountains
That rustled their fronds on that glittering sky,
hadow, a lean dark shadow,
A dreaming shadow that drifted by;
m whisper the strange dark music
That found it so "rich to die."

muring palms of San Diego
Shook with stars as he passed beneath.
palms, and the wild white orchards,

The night, and its roses, were all one breath,
ing of a nightingale seaward,
A song that had out-soared death.



COMPENSATIONS

flash that rends the blue
 Shall fall the avenging sword.
evening dew
 Descends the mighty Lord.

balances are made
 To move with moon and tide;
mercy be afraid
 Nor justice be denied.

that seemed to waste away,
 The kindness forgot,
in your heart today
 Although you knew them not.

not forget his road,
 Nor the high stars their rhyme,
with the heavier load
 Has one less hill to climb.

darker shadow fall
 On every struggling age,
even if, after all,

He share our pilgrimage?

ourn is not the end.

The dust has nimble wings.

beauty have a friend

At the deep heart of things.

eak? What friend belies

His love with idle breath?

ach others' eyes,

And ask no more in death.



DEAD MAN'S MORRICE

ie a crowder to the Mermaid Inn,

One dark May night,

e that quelled our motley din,

With quaint delight,

et, as old lost airs will do,

A phantom strain:

nce, lest I should look for you,

And look in vain.

od, where ghosts of lovers walk,

At fall of day,

l fragments of their ancient talk

As poor ghosts may,

nat brushed their faces, wet with dew,

Or tears, or rain,...

nce, lest I should look for you,

And look in vain.

een them—pale forgotten shades

That do return,

iose dim paths, those fragrant glades,

Those nooks of fern,

nat, of the may they knew,

No wraiths remain;

ook, as I should look for you,
And look in vain.

the happier ghosts that waned away—
Whither, who knows?—
Come back with music and the may,
And Spring's first rose,
To sing the old burden through,
Stave and refrain:
Hence, lest I should look for you,
And look in vain.

Oh, if in that starless deep,
I lose your eyes,
Liar places. I'll not keep
Tryst in the skies.
Whispering elms that found us true,
The old grass-grown lane.
Here, lest I should look for you,
And look in vain.

And, under the dreaming moon,
A phantom throng
In the fern, to a ghostly morrice tune,
A thin sweet song,
With hands, eyes drown in eyes anew,
Lips meet again....
Hence, lest I should look for you,
And look in vain.

THE OLD FOOL IN THE WOOD

Whisper you all I know,"
Said the Old Fool in the Wood,
Say that green leaves grow.
You'd say, 'Ah, what a happy mood
Must be in today,
To think such thoughts,'
You'd say."

Whisper you all I've heard,"
Said the Old Fool in the fern,
Say the song of a bird.
You'd say, 'I'll listen, and p'raps I'll learn
His joy as He passed this way,
One syllable more,'
You'd say."

Whisper you all the rest,"
Said the Old Fool under the skies,
Your griefs against your breast
And whisper with love-lit eyes,
The sorrow that made the may,
And the pulse of His heart,'
You'd say."

A NEW MADRIGAL TO AN OLD MELODY

(It is supposed that Shadow-of-a-Leaf uses the word "clear" in a more ancient sense of "beautiful.")

dark pine-bough, in slender white mystery

 The moon lay to listen, above the thick fern,
ming wood that is older than history

 I heard a lad sing, and I stilled me to learn;
ltd his long-forgot litany,—

Fall, April; fall, April, in dew on our dearth!
nd bring poppy, bring deep sleepy dittany
 For Marian, our clear May, so long laid in earth.

ack the branches. I saw him that chanted it.

 I saw his fool's bauble. I knew his old grief.
d greenwood and the shadow that haunted it,—

 My fool, my lost jester, my *Shadow-of-a-Leaf*!
said, "why, all this while, have you left me so
 Luckless in melody, lonely in mirth?"
sang, "why has this world then bereft me so
 Soon of my Marian, so long laid in earth?

hat are gone," he said, "love was more fortunate.

 Grief was our minstrel of things that endure.
d dust and this world grow importunate.

 Time has no sorrow that time cannot cure.
d lose, and the loss was worth cherishing.

Now, we may win, but, O, where is the worth?
rue love," he whispered, "are perishing,
With Marian, our clear May, so long laid in earth."

id, "no! Since we grieve for our grief again,
Touch the old strings! Let us try the old stave!
may wake, like my *Shadow-of-a-Leaf* again,
Singing of hope, in the dark, by a grave."
together—that long-forgot litany:—
Fall, April; fall, April; bring new grief to birth.
'b of grace, and bring deep healing dittany,
For Marian, our clear May, so long laid in earth.

THE LOST BATTLE

yet—the fight

Where those immortal dreamers failed.

the citadels of night

And the night praised them—and prevailed.

the cause was lost

We scarce distinguish friend from foe;

and can help it most—

The armies of the dead will grow.

all our banners now,

And filched our watchwords for its own.

crowns the "rebel's" brow

And millions crowd his lordly throne.

we altered. Names are names;

They praise the "truth" that is not true.

at the world acclaims

Is not the rebel Shelley knew.

ould that Commonwealth.

We may not reach the goal we set.

lag they dare not steal.

Forward! It is not over yet.

ist and under dust

Before we end that ancient wrong;

word that cannot rust,

And where's the death can touch a song?

bodies rot in earth

The singing souls that once were ours,

h light and helmed with mirth,

Shall front the kingdoms and the powers.

e is on its throne,

And half the living still forget;

dead are all our own,

Courage, it is not over yet.



RIDDLES OF MERLIN

alking

Alone by the sea,
whisper?"

Said Merlin to me.

ered,

"The sigh of the wave"—

ied Merlin,

"'Tis the grass on your grave."

ing

In churchyard ground
Merlin,

"What is that sound?"

ass is growing,"

I answered; but he

h, no!

'Tis the sound of the sea."

eward

e shore,

crimson?"

Said Merlin once more.

, "I said.

st"—

ist," he said,

"Sunrise for West."



THE SYMPHONY

in happy eyes

Fades, fades away:

-coloured skies

Whisper farewell.

er the strings of the heart may stray

In fugitive melodies;

nd of the Master must not stay,

Even for a breath;

; one joy, or even to dwell

On one rich chord of pain,

lse of the song, would untune heaven

And drown the stars in death.

its love-note dies;

And beauty fades in the air,

aster-symphony immortal,

And find new life and deeper wonder there.

PEACE

e pulse of the tide again
And the slow lapse of the leaves,
old of a field of grain
And a bird in the nested eaves;

smack in the old harbour
Where all was happy and young;
or two of the songs I knew
When songs could still be sung.

npty my heart of all
This world's implacable roar,
urn to my home, and fall
Asleep in my home once more;

orget what the cities say,
And the folly of all the wise,
y own true folk this day,
And the love in their constant eyes.

, peace, where the sea-birds wheel,
And peace in the breaking wave;
roken heart to heal,

And a broken soul to save.



THE OPEN DOOR

Y of life,
our strife,
Defeats, mistakes,
we see
ctory,
The tired heart breaks.

g years give
how to live,
Life's end draws near;
being ours,
ur new powers
In worlds elsewhere.

oul whose wings
uffering, springs
To life anew,
have some room
nd the tomb,
And mercy, too.

hout this dream
uintest gleam
Answers our "why";

all its race

leave no trace

On that blind sky;

lose that door

gged for,

Seal the soul's doom;

niverse

vering curse,

One lampless tomb?

ream, the creed

r God, indeed,

For God, and man,

r whereby

world no lie

And crown His plan.



IMMORTAL SAILS

breath, we'll burst those gates of gold,
And ransack heaven before our moment fails.
With, before we, too, grow old,
We'll mount and sing and spread immortal sails.

That makes eternity.
Love and an hour may quite out-run the years,
More to hear and more to see
Than life can wash away with all its tears.

The part, at last, that sunset sky
Shall not be touched with deeper hues than this;
Hide the lightning ere we die
And seize our brief infinitude of bliss,

Prepare for all that heaven can tell,
Meet eyes, and look their last farewell.

THE MATIN-SONG OF FRIAR TUCK

I.

d sing to heaven's high King
As blackbirds pipe on earth,
licious courts would ring
With gusts of lovely mirth!
bed throng could lift a song
So mellow with righteous glee
bird that all day long
Delights my hawthorn tree.
Hark! That's the thrush
With speckled breast
From yon white bush
Chaunting his best,
Te Deum! Te Deum laudamus!

II.

ms be touched with gleams
Of Paradisal air,
erchance, of earth may glance
Around our slumbers there;
of may might drift our way

With scents of leaf and loam,
g bird at dawn be heard
From those old woods of home.
Hark! That's the thrush
With speckled breast
From yon white bush
Chaunting his best,
Te Deum! Te Deum laudamus!

III.

iest shall mar my feast
Where'er my soul may range.
of heaven's good cheer
Unless our Master change.
h's night is dying away,
If I might choose my bliss,
ld say, at break of day,
With her first waking kiss:-
Hark! That's the thrush
With speckled breast,
From yon white bush
Chaunting his best,
Te Deum! Te Deum laudamus!

FIVE CRITICISMS

I.

(On many recent novels by the conventional unconventionalists.)

ALOON, lean-witted, dour and rich,
After grim years of soul-destroying greed,
ine, that April-blooded witch
"Too young" to know that gold was not her need.

errot, young, rebellious, warm,
With well-lined purse, to teach the fine-souled wife
ool's gold should aid a world-reform
(Confused with sex). This wrecks the old fool's life.

doubt that Pierrot was clever,
Quick to break hearts and quench the dying flame;
his own pride, does Pierrot never
Choose his own mate, work for his own high aim,

æet, and pay for his own tune?
eat, rob and kill poor Pantaloon?

II.

(On a certain goddess, acclaimed as "new" but known in Babylon.)

sembled artists of our day

Waiting for light, for music and for song.

And before them, fresh as May

And beautiful; but, in that modish throng,

They said, "In our first youth

Surely, long since, your hair was touched with grey."

She answered, "I am Truth."

"Old and banal," they sneered, and turned away.

Formless thing, with breasts dyed scarlet.

The roses in her hair were green and blue.

"I am new," she said. "I change, and

Death knows why."

Eyes and gesture of a harlot

She led them all forth, whinneying, "New, how new!

Tell us your name!" She answered, "The New Lie."

III.

(On Certain of the Bolshevik "Idealists.")

the force and thought you waste in rage

Over your neighbor's house, or heart of stone,

You built your own new heritage,

O fools, have you no hands, then, of your own?

pride? Is this your answer still,

 This the red flag that burns above our strife,
why that rings from Pisgah hill,

"Our neighbor's money, or our neighbor's life"?

let us build that nobler state

 With our own hands, with our own muscle and brain!
ories die in hymns of hate;

 And your own envies are your heaviest chain.

el proud enough to say

on our own feet, and win the day"?

IV.

(On Certain Realists.)

he quick sardonic eye

ckeries of life,

s dark masque of things that seem,

tragic irony,

scern in this our mortal strife,

trap you, also, with a dream.

w a dead man borne along

s, passing a boisterous throng

ised to laugh and shout and dance:

et,
son bitter minds might brew
like this, I knew
Truth would not permit her glance
led by flying straws of chance,
yes on deeper skies are set,
tragic ironists forget.

ead man's life, from birth to death,—
ew of love and sin and pain,
ailure (not as this world sees),
s passions, inner loss and gain,
darker tides of constant law
argin of this life she saw
ft his body with the breath.
to her, were still realities.

d for him unseen,
, too.
not pretend
colder, or his God less true,
ve, at length, would be less green.

/

depths of her eternal sky
ve a boundless universe,
emed to man's unseeing eye
further to fare worse;
e assume he lacked that unseen friend
ie tragic ironists declare
an the seen, in his last end.

are, beware,
ong name of "reality"
rselfes anew with shapes of air,
agnostics, who re-write
creeds of night,
ow your own Unknowable,
vingéd soul in a new hell;
lip-worshippers of Truth,
e heart of youth;
the realists, who fight
, and forget your own pure light;
who, with a little shroud
n the sightless faces of the dead,
world, and keep the mourner bowed
st, with stones, real stones, for bread;
ok one eighth of an inch beneath
in of death,
urselves discoverers of the skull
ento mori of our faith;
who hunt a flying wraith
lissolving stuff of hill and cloud;
who, at the last, annul
t with your kind;
who darken heart and mind,
; soul in bondage to a dream,
once more to things that seem.

V

(An Answer)

[After reading an article in a leading London journal by an "intellectual" who attacked one of the noblest poets and greatest artists of a former century (or any century) on the ground that his high ethical standards were incompatible with the new lawlessness. This vicious lawlessness the writer described definitely, and he paid his tribute to dishonour as openly and brutally as any of the Bolsheviki could have done. I had always known that this was the real ground of the latter-day onslaught on some of the noblest literature of the past; but I had never seen it openly confessed before. The time has now surely come when, if our civilization is to make any fight at all against the new "red ruin and breaking up of laws," we must cease to belaud our slack-minded, latter-day "literature of rebellion" for its cleverness in making scraps of paper out of the plain laws of right and wrong. It has been doing this for more than twenty-five years, and the same has become fashionable among those who are too busy to read carefully or understand fully what pitfalls are being prepared for their own feet and the feet of their children.]

I

rue, England indeed were dead.

 If the wild fashion of that poisonous hour
 Wherein the new Salome, clothed with power,
hissed, with hands and feet so red,
ow demand that glorious head,
 Whose every word was like an English flower,
 Whose every song an English April shower,
hought immortal wine and bread;
ie, if England should prefer
 Darkness, corruption, and the adulterous crew,

nd Browning would cry shame on her,
And Milton would deny the land he knew;
o died in Flanders yesterday
heir God they sleep in cleaner clay.

II

Only these "rebel" wings,
These glittering clouds of "intellectual" flies
Out of the stagnant pools of midnight rise
lead creeds, with carrion-poisoned stings
They strike at noble and ignoble things,
Immortal Love with the old world's out-worn lies,
But even now, a wind from clearer skies
moke their coteries and wings.

orced idealist re-divorces
The wife he stole from his own stealing friend!
uld pluck the high stars from their courses,
And mock the fools that praise them, till the end!
hole world praise them. Truth can wait
ngland shall unlock the gate.

III

ools go paint themselves with woad,
For we've a jest between us, Truth and I.
We know that those who live by fashion die
n, and that mode kills mode.

great new age is on the road,
And death is at the heart of every lie.
But we've a jest between us, Truth and I.
locked the doors to our abode.

eat new "rebel" in his pride
Should pass that way and hear us laughing low
i the darkness, side by side,
He might catch this:—"The dullards do not know
e names. New 'rebel' is old 'thrall.'"
lonely dreamers after all.

THE COMPANIONS

re they that voyage through the night
On that eternal quest,
ge light beyond our light,
That rest beyond our rest.

, seeking beauty, once descry
Her face, to most unknown;
ke changelings from the sky
Must walk their road alone.

med. So idle was my mood;
But now, before these eyes,
ul trenches, black with blood,
What radiant legions rise!

s over the wounded earth awakes
Like wild-flowers in the Spring.
rtal chrysalis breaks
Immortal wing on wing.

flowers, they wander on wings of light,
Through realms beyond our ken.
soul is companied tonight

By hosts of unknown men.



THE LITTLE ROADS

roads are all grown over
That seemed so firm and white.
Dark forests have covered them.
How should I walk aright?
I thread these tangled mazes,
Or grope to that far off light?
I find the thickets, and they turn me
Back to the thickets and the night.

Yes, at a word, an elfin pass-word,
(O, thin, deep, sweet with beaded rain!)
I thread through a mist of ragged-robins,
The old lost April-coloured lane,
I find from myself; for, at a whisper,
Where the strong limbs thrust in vain,
My heart help another heart,
The path shines out for me again.

I find a rambling lane for lovers
To the light of the world's one May,
While drifting flakes may wet our faces
As we lift them to the bloom-bowed spray:
All we ask Thee, then, for high-roads,
Or down upon our knees and pray

t ever lose us in Thy little lanes,
And lead us by a wandering way.



SUNLIGHT AND SEA

e sunlight and the sea
l take my heaven from me?

un, Life of the Sun,
companion,
laughters round me run,
of the blue air
e kisses everywhere,
limb, flushing the cheek,
t, leopard-sleek,
thy red-curtained East
-girl to my feast,
her lord, the Spring,
y those anklets ring;
like a white Greek maid
through the dancing shade,
a green-veined leaf imprints
ib with emerald tints,
t her silken shape
endour still escape,
osts of roses flow
le rose and snow.

fairest is thy face,

t, when we embrace,
ite sand sleeps at noon
nely blue lagoon,
one white reef of coral
-birds faintly quarrel
ers on the reef
eam of grief,
trees overhead
ll grief is dead.

t, lead me then
ig seas again....
swim out, side by side,
rith his bride,
are salt with brine,
eyes flash in mine,
a mightier sea
r blood in harmony.
imal flood of being,
peech, too near for seeing;
rt, new reconciled,
kes his earth-bound child.

itial secret spells
tic syllables,—
ng, ebbing, flowing,—
m past all knowing.
ea, I hear, I hear,
usic of the sphere,
hm of sun and star,

at light and darkness are;
mings of a rhyme
yond the tides of time;
rhythm in blood and breath,
e song of life and death.
and rest content,
primal element,
nt whence life arose,
outh, to which it goes.

unlight and the sea
l take my heaven from me?



THE ROAD THROUGH CHAOS

I.

road, one only, to the Light:

A narrow way, but Freedom walks therein;
n road through Chaos and old Night,
And all these wandering Jack-o-Lents of Sin.

of Law, where Pilate stays

To hear, at last, the answer to his cry;
ages, groping through their maze
Of eager questions, hear a child reply.

s *Truth*? Come, look upon my tables.

Begin at your beginnings once again.
vo! Though all the rest be fables,
Here's one poor glimpse of Truth to keep you sane.

irst, is clean accord with fact,
ie or thought, or word, or act.

II.

at first, those clean, precise, accords,
Build to the Lord your temples and your song;
beauty, music's wedded chords
Resolving into heaven all hate and wrong.

of colour marry and follow
And breaking waves in a rhythmic dance ensue;
thought fly free as the wings of the swallow,
Whose arrowy curves obey their measure, too.

marching stars and tides befriend you,
And your own heart, and the world's heart, pulse in rhyme;
mob of the passions that would rend you
Crown you their Captain and march on in time.

repossess your struggling soul,
world, and find the eternal goal.

THE NIGHT OF THE LION

*"And that a reply be received before midnight."
British Ultimatum.*

was at twelve of the night,
When the graves give up their dead.
In the City, no light
Yellowed the clouds overhead.
The Lion stands there's a star,
But his column is lost in the gloom;
The doors are ajar,
And the Lion awakes, and the doom.

chosen race.
His strength is the strength of the skies,
And all nations have place,
In whose downfall Liberty dies.
But he is just.
He shall live to the end of years.
And the proud to the dust.
He shall raise the weak to the spheres.

the world's great mart,
But the brooding hush is awake
In the heart of a steady heart

That calls like the drum of Drake,
muttering deep
As the pulse of the distant guns,
before the leap
Thro' the rolling thoroughfare runs.

ded men go by
Like thoughts in the Lion's brain.
s lift on high
Like the slow waves of his mane
wing lids conceal
The furnaces of his eyes.
gone out. They reveal
ch-lights of steel
Steadily sweeping the skies.

l he had peace in his lair
Where the bones of old tyrannies lay,
; that his cubs have stripped bare,
The old skulls they still toss in their play.
s are risen again,
And the last light dies from their path;
ght of his mane
Lifts to the stars with his wrath.

to the West he is crouching.
He snuffs at the North-East wind.
n Britain is couching.
His haunches quiver on Ind.

ck night, where he lies;
But a kingdom and a fleet
his terrible eyes
s, and the darkness dies
With the War-gods under his feet.

*Then a little child,
Shall lay but a hand on his mane,
How golden and mild
And he stands in the heavens again;
The seventh seal,
Which the Lion alone shall rend,
From their courses reel,
His Freedom shall not end.*

THE WAR WIDOW

I.

SMILED, black-gowned, she rides in bus and train,
With eyes that fill too listlessly for tears.
Hands clasp and unclasp again.
Good News, they cry. She neither sees nor hears.

Perhaps, may crown some far-off king.
Good News may peel the glory of the state—
May cause the courts of heaven to ring.
She sees a hand waved at a garden gate.

Ears are tuned to other themes;
And her dim eyes can never see aright.
A ghost—through all her April dreams,
To meet his eyes at dawn, his lips at night.

Truth that others never knew;
Her—the only truth that's true.

II.

Good News! There is no way but this.

Out of the night a star begins to rise.
Here my soul's deep Master is;
Nor can I hear those angels in the skies;

Now, as childhood used of old,
By radiant seas, in those time-hallowed tales.
So, implacable and cold,
From this blind gloom, stand out the iron nails.

The world's heart stands the Eternal Cross,
The ultimate frame of moon and star and sun,
With out-stretched arms, in utter loss,
Points East and West and makes the whole world one.

Good News! There is no hope, no way,
Life, but leads through Christmas Day.

THE BELL

The Bell was out of tune,
The melodied sun and moon.

Calling folk to prayer
The still in the air.

Coming, from north to south,
The wind's mouth.

As beneath it died,
The red, so loud it lied.

He told the blue-robed bonze:
"Only wrought of bronze.

Do, *cast it again,*
Make the heavens in vain."

The mighty cauldron hissed,
The wealth that no man missed.

With light silver, they brought gold,

em into the seething mould.

ught his greening hoard,
cast in his sword.

Bell in the Temple swung,
ars with its harsh tongue.

*est?" the oracle said,
u better drunk or dead."*

ey melted it down,
cast in his crown.

red wine, and bullock's blood,
rey, seething flood.

nellowing fruits to eat,
mbs to make it sweet.

y hauled it to the sky,
one star-shattering lie.

rd time and the last,
it down to be re-cast.

metal seethed anew,

I shrank as the heat grew;

bed woman, queenly and tall,
brink before them all,

re a golden fruit lay bare;
mall son feeding there.

im off, she lifted him high,
fruit on the blue sky.

er lips to the budded feet,
d softly, "*Oh, sweet, my sweet.*"

l, "*Gods, that my land may live,
that I have to give!*"

fore the throng awoke,
/ from their white lips broke,

n into the fiery flood,
baby, her flesh and blood.

hissing waves closed round
m through without a sound.

' *pain*," they heard her say,

ed, once, and she turned away.

ell, in peace and war,
asure of sun and star.

s, in the night it cries
voice replies:

mother, the Bell rings true!—

*You were all that I had!—Oh, mother, my mother!—
and the Bell it is well. Is it well,*

Is it well with the heart that had you and none other?

SLAVE AND EMPEROR

"Our cavalry have rescued Nazareth from the enemy whose supermen described
Christianity as a creed for slaves."

or mocked at Nazareth
In his almighty hour.
bowed himself to death
with slaves in Nazareth,
words but wasted breath
Before that "will to power"?

kest hour of all,
When black defeat began,
heard the mountains quake,
ives beneath him shake,
s legions rally and break,
And he whimpered as they ran.

t that moves the earth,
A cry that wakes the dead!
ll me whence they come,
ssengers are dumb?
s this that comes to birth
And breaks my power?" he said.

nd his foundering guns,
Though dawn was now not far,

filled with a living fear
d at the Emperor's ear,
f the dead draw near
Beneath an eastern star."

lows in Nazareth.
The Slave is risen again.
er wastes of death
ride from Nazareth,
r we mocked as wasted breath
Returns, in power, to reign;
hite, through Nazareth,
To save His world again.

ON A MOUNTAIN TOP

an altar, fringed with ferns
That darken against the sky,
Lonely beauty burns
And all our evils die.

A sea that roared below
Is quieter than the dew,
The clouds that flow
Across the stainless blue.

At rest, the angels kneel
And breathe the sweets that rise
Too little to reveal
Their beauty to our eyes.

Flowers on the earth
With queenly blooms arrayed;
The fairest come to birth,
The smallest flowers He made.

And the sounding pine,
And richer, sweeter far,
The celandine wakes. The celandine

Looks at the morning star.

see the heavens unfold.

They breathe no out-worn prayer;
ntain, as of old,

His glory fills the air.



EARLY POEMS

(Not Published Hitherto in America)



THE PHANTOM FLEET

(1904)

lingered in the pale green West:

 In rosy wastes the low soft evening star
he last white sea-mew sought for rest;
 And tawny sails came stealing o'er the bar.

side cottage, through the panes

 The light streamed like a thin far trumpet-call,
d, as with quivering battle-stains,
 The printed ships that decked the parlour wall.

ames old admirals looked down:

 They saw the lonely slumberer at their feet:
paper, headed *Talk from Town*;
 Our rusting trident, and our phantom fleet:

ighbouring tavern surged a song

 Of England laughing in the face of war,
onquerably proud and strong,
 And lips triumphant from her Trafalgar.

umberer in that glimmering room,

 Saw distant waters glide and heave and gleam;

in the softly coloured gloom
The pictures clustered slowly to a dream.

England, resting on her past,
Among the faded garlands of her dead,
Hisper reached her heart at last,
And once again she raised her steel-clad head.

filled with sudden strange alarms;
She heard the westering waters change and chime;
distant tumult of her arms
Defeated, not by courage, but by Time.

id made a deadlier pact with death,
Nor strength nor steel availed against that bond:
ched—and Britain held her breath—
The battle booming from the deeps beyond.

larkness rolled upon the wind,
Threatening the torch that Britain held on high?
navies, baffled, broken, blind,
Slunk backward, snarling in their agony!
Who guards the gates of Freedom now? The cry
on! England, the shattered ramparts fall!
Then, like a trumpet shivering through the sky
lightning rending the black pall
answer pealed: *Her dead shall hear that call.*

listant light of great waves breaking

That brought the sunset on each crumbling crest,
f buried ages waking,

And mighty spirits rising from their rest;

Then ghostly clouds arose, with billowing breast,
that turned to sails upon their way,

Red clouds that burned like flags against the West,
onquering fleet in silence lay
at strange old light, and night grew bright as day.

ght for Freedom! The great East

Heard, and was rent asunder like a veil.

it out of the night increased

Its towering clouds and crowded zones of sail:

England, our England, canst thou faint or fail?

ght for Freedom yet once more!

This, this is ours at least! Count the great tale
ad that rise to guard thy shore
e red life they never feared to pour.

ght for Freedom! On they came,

One cloud of beauty sweeping the wild sea;
ough all their thousands, flashed like flame

That star-born signal of the Victory:

Duty, that deathless lantern of the free;

kes a god of every man.

And there was Nelson, watching silently
e phantom fleet the message ran;
igate rushed before the stormy van.

elson, frail and maimed and blind,
 Stretched out his dead cold face against the foe:
; Raleigh followed hard behind,
 With all his eager fighting heart aglow;
 Glad, glad for England's sake once more to know
' battle and contempt of pain;
lie, if England willed it so,
nd the coward's death again;
orld back now as once he hurled back Spain.

he all those others, Drake and Blake,
 Rodney and Howard, Byron, Collingwood;
; eyes aflame for England's sake,
 As on their ancient decks they proudly stood,—
 Decks washed of old with England's purplest blood;
e more, each rushing oaken side
 Bared its dark-throated, thirsty, gleaming brood
atched by laughing lads who died
o for England and her ancient pride.

ght for England! The great sea
 In a wild light of song began to break
l phantom of the Victory
 And all the foam was music in her wake:
 Ship after phantom ship, with guns a-rake
flags a-stream from every mast
 Moved in a deepening splendour, not to make
ngland of her own dead past;
ing dream to arm her soul at last.

e for England: through the hush

Of gathered nations rose that regal cry,
Unshaken walls one word could crush

If those vast armoured throats dared to reply:
But there the most implacable enemy
Still with gladder, prouder tears,

As Nelson's calm eternal face went by,
And all perishable fears
Their goal above the waste of years.

Unshaken fleets the vision streamed away,

Then slowly turned once more to that deep West,
And cried, O, England, the new day

Is dawning, but thy soul can take no rest.

And thy peace are only thine

By right of toil on every land and sea
And crimson sacrificial wine

Of thine own heart and thine own agony.

Unshaken. Peace, in every hour,

Throbs like the heart of music. This alone
Can inherit and confirm that power

Whereof the past is but the cushioned throne.

Yet! Again and yet again,

Hear us who storm thy heart with this one cry.
We cannot help, though fair and fain,

To hold thy seas before thee, and to die.

et! Thy fleet, the first, last line:

The sword of Liberty, her strength, her shield,
life-blood! Britain, it is thine,
Here, now, to hold that birth-right, or to yield.

e dark, those phantom ships of old

Faded, it seemed, through mists of blood and tears.
clouds, and slowly westward rolled
The sad returning pageant of the years.

ht, where all our tumults cease,

Through that rich West, the Victory returned;
ives around her whispered "peace,"
And from her mast no battle-message burned.

ke fragments of those fading skies,

The pageant passed, with all its misty spars,
hed nations raised their dreaming eyes
To that great light which brings the end of wars.

), in some strange glory drowned,

Cloud after cloud, was lost in that deep light
ocean stillness haloed round.

Then—that high fleet of stars led on the night.

MICHAEL OAKTREE

arch of glorious leaves I passed
od and saw the sickle moon
ylight o'er the pale green sea.

et hour before the sun
ouds to prayer and silently
ediction on the waves
round the death-bed of the day.
were returning from the farms
lanced to meet them. From the doors
ere came a pleasant clink
ands laid out the evening meal.
ring elms around the village spire
and sank the caw of gathering rooks.
ned clouds were listening to the tale
o the sunset with one sigh.
wistful sea-bird sought for peace,
shing-boat stole o'er the bar,
grasses, murmuring a prayer,
ether to the holy west,
ether thro' the golden hush,
hush, the solemn scented hush,
r hush of eventide.

g the ferns that crowned the hill
green and whispers of the wind,
, carelessly linking hands,
en dream drifted away.
fternoon of scent and song
Oaktree died. It was not much
; but indeed I think he longed
it of summer once again
er the far blue hills. I know
e his rough-hewn wooden bench
sun outside the cottage door
istening stillness he could hear,
ving gilly-flowers that crowned
garden wall, the long low sigh
eace that whispers to the hills
nsolation of the sea.
pe for much: he longed to live
er came again, he said;
t sweet eve of May he died.

dly through the dreaming lanes
ottage on that afternoon;
wn old Michael Oaktree now
s, so many happy years.
ttle he had carried me
ick to see the harvest home,
many a ride upon his wagon
sty scents of sun and hay.
e how to snare the bulky trout
nder the bank of yonder brook.

ght me many a country craft,
to learn, and, as I learnt,
cher of that homely lore.
oyish heart he shared the glad
ie suns and winds and waves,
ldhood what it hungered for—
i-wisdom of the primal man.

ed his childhood: Death for him
error than his bed. He walked
l sunlight like a brother, glad
anionship and mutual aid.
er truth, are weaned too soon
ark arms and naked barbarous breast.
soon, we leave the golden feast,
cing limbs and pluck the crown
the dreaming brow. We pass
ost laborious idleness.
ost the meaning of the world;
out into the night too soon;
iken all the means of grace
d our small power to learn.
move so swiftly over us:
tle time to live in worlds
d unknown realms of joy,
before we learn how vain
s, how fruitlessly we cast
on the waters, and how weak
re, but our chance desires how strong!
ark, our sense of light decays;

to God as once we cried!
om, our faith, perhaps our love,
1 years that never can return.

Daktree was a man whose love
ned through all his eighty years.
hardly faith. He seemed a part
believed in. He had lived
nversation with the sun,
silence and the heart of peace;
mmunion with the Power
action and all tides of thought,
cret courses of the stars;
it still establishes on earth
rship, through the radiant laws
and Beauty; for through these
ree portals of the self-same gate
an attains infinity,
o Godhead. So he gained
e-taste of Nirvana, not
istern dream, but the desire
l of us, whether thro' lives
by slow degrees, we near
ne, or from this breaking body
th we flash at once to God.
le love and simple faith, this man
ght above the hope of kings.

shut the little gate
cross the garden, all the scents

lossom ached like inmost pain
part, I know not why. They seemed
ict as distant evening bells
he sea, a secret chime
id breaks and breaks upon the heart
er than in sound, a chime
reak of sunset to the moon,
ose upon a starlit grave,
nile upon a dead man's lips;
elancholy, mute as death
love, uttered in plangent tones
le, jasmine, gilly-flowers,
romatic musky leaves,
s to the rose-wreathed porch.

d and entered and was drawn
om of the dying man,
ped up with pillows, quietly
rough his open casement far
hispers of the gilly-flowers
ellow light of eventide
st once more; and, as he gazed,
saw so great a peace
n face. There was no sound
mbrous pulsing of a clock,
f the garden and, far off,
nsolation of the sea.

: his bed-side: she had passed
year; her only child was dead.

wedded more than sixty years,
izing with the man she loved
to that unknown Deep.

ated into the room
n, pausing awhile to bask
ainted fans on the warm sill;
n the roses and there came
ess mother's ears a sound
hing children, far away.

Oaktree took his wife's thin hand
ig rough hands. His eyes grew dark,
ned to her and died, he spoke
perfect faith and love—*Come soon!*

ne world there was no sound
mbrous pulsing of a clock,
f the leaves and far away,
ompassion of the sea.
passed out of the porch
cross the garden, all the scents
lossoms ached like inmost joy,
ore, but like one heavenly choir
ystic music, still and strange
he holy Seraphim,
idoration, mute as love,
death, and pure with wedded tones
le, jasmine, gilly-flowers,

romatic musky leaves,
s to the garden gate.

I knew how closely knit
owers we are, how many means
are for those that never lose
membership in this divine
for those that all their days
in quiet communion with the Life
e common secret of the sun,
silence and the heart of man.
God, one Love, one everlasting
carnation, one creative
d the many-coloured veil.

ured God's face with partial truths,
all our sorrow and sin, our wars
hought, in this unheavened world.
tle of our partial truths,
ist the present and the swift
ssing joy against the deep
ver the weaker truth
onger, till once more we near
splendour of the whole. Our God
ong a partial God. We are all
nage, men and birds and beasts,
d clouds and cataracts and suns,
at Beings above our little world,
nd for every depth below,
rgotten Princedoms, Virtues, Powers,

at live and move in realms
our thought as Europe lies
the arts and sciences
comprehension of the worm.
tial images, we need
and us to complete our souls;
souls are filled with a desire
th lead us towards the Infinity
that awaits us each and all.

ough the dreaming lanes I went.
and the birds were hushed. The stars
blossoms in the purple trees.
ed upon the whispering hill
ght still lingered in the west,
soft against that rosy depth
stood knee-deep in the ferns.
dead man's youth were in my heart,
glad; and as the moon
ey kissed; and, linking hand in hand,
lamp-lit home drifted away.

of leaves, into the gloom
he little woodland road,
he breathless hedge of hawthorn heard
pening night, the long low sigh
pace that whispers to the hills
t and sabbath of the sea.

TOUCHSTONE ON A BUS

I rode with Touchstone on a bus
Hill to World's End. It was he!
oadcloth and the bowler hat,
ouchstone, the wild flower of folly,
e of his age, the scourge of kings,
orning star of elfin-land,
vrap his legs around his neck
n winter nights. He had slipped back,
en were doing in a world
e wiser. He had watched a play,
ooks, heard men discourse of art
he sat bubbling like a spring
er did blackbird, drenched with may,
uchstone chuckled on that ride.
world! Lord, what a mad, mad world!
olt and jingle of the engine,
his bunch of madcap rhymes:—

THE NEW DUCKLING

I

THE NEW DUCKLING

be new," said the duckling.

"O, ho!" said the wise old owl,
sea-hen cluttered off chuckling
To tell all the rest of the fowl.

a more elegant figure,"
That child of a duck went on.
to grow bigger and bigger,
Until I could swallow a swan.

bond slave of habit,
I *won't* have these webs on my toes.
ound like a rabbit,
A rabbit as red as a rose.

o waddle like mother,
Or quack like my silly old dad.
terly other,

And *frightfully* modern and mad."

," said the turkey, "you're quacking!
creeping up thro' the rye;
not utterly lacking,
You'll make for that duck-pond. Good-bye!"

the duckling. "I'll lift him
A beautiful song, like a sheep;
ave—as it were—biffed him,
I'll give him my feathers to keep."

us end of this fable,
So far as the rest ascertained,
eached from the barn to the stable,
Was that *only his feathers remained*.

he bond slave of habit,
And he *didn't* have webs on his toes;
he runs round like a rabbit,
A rabbit as red as a rose.

II

THE MAN WHO DISCOVERED THE USE OF A CHAIR

ho discovered the use of a chair,

Odds—bobs—
What a wonderful man!
down on it, tearing his hair,
Till he thought of a highly original plan.
ad sat on his chair, like you,
Quite—still!
But his looks were grim
to be famous (as great men do)
And nobody ever would listen to him.

one night to a dinner of state
Hear! hear!
In the proud Guildhall!
his chair, and he ate from a plate;
But nobody heard his opinions at all;

11 fat aldermen down for a speech
(Grouse! Grouse!
What a dreary bird!)
minutes allotted to each,
But never a moment for *him* to be heard.

g ready to talk, I suppose,
Order! Order!
They cried, *for the Chair!*
their wonder, our friend arose
And fastened his eye on the eye of the Mayor.

ie," he said, "to the fourteenth course!

*"High—time,
for the Chair,"* he said.
th of his hands, and with all of his force,
He hurled his chair at the Lord Mayor's head.

head by the width of a hair.
Gee—whizz!
What a horrible squeak!
through the big bay-window there
And smashed a bus into Wednesday week.

next day, in the decorous Times
*(Great—Guns—
How the headlines ran!)*
kings and the wars and the crimes,
There were five full columns about that man.

ENVOI

dizzy when authors write
*(My stars!
And you very well may!)*
black and that black is white,
You should sit, quite still, in your chair and say:

gh to be famous now,
*(Puff—Puff!
How the trumpets blare!)*
ourse, that you don't care how,

Like the man who discovered the use of a chair.

III

COTTON-WOOL

rush and shun the pen,
s of clever men,
ove that black is white,
ear that wrong is right,
ast the singing stars
s, in between the bars,

*Children, let a wandering fool
Stuff your ears with cotton-wool.*

a clever man
y as you can.
er, never, never
rates was clever.
thing I ever knew
alnuts at the Zoo.

*Children, let a wandering fool
Stuff your ears with cotton-wool.*

not scintillate.
as merely great.
lifferent matter
ike a frantic hatter.

lley had no tricks.
ever climbed up sticks.

*Children, let a wandering fool
Stuff your ears with cotton-wool.*

l create a gloom
idon drawing-room;
at their wit,
er laugh at it.
ised Salome's toes,
ort and blow his nose.

*Children, let a wandering fool
Stuff your ears with cotton-wool.*

im for a silly clown,
im out of London town.
lkey, the historian,
was a dull Victorian.
k, and Luke and John,
I rest upon.

*Children, let a wandering fool
Stuff your ears with cotton-wool.*

Amen.

IV

FASHIONS

n fashion on fashion,

(With only the truth growing old!)
new purple of passion,
(And love waiting out in the cold)
Who'll buy?

ing new lamps for Aladdin,
New worlds for the old and the true;
members the story
The magic was not in the new.

ing a new rose for Eden,
A rose of green glass. I suppose
; wrong with their rose is
The fact that it isn't a rose.
Who'll buy?

song without metre;
And, here again, nothing is wrong;
n earth could be neater)
Except that—it isn't a song.

your hands. It's the latest!
And feet are Victorian now;
best and our greatest
Before that dread epithet bow.
Who'll buy?

goes for a song, now.

The sixties had horrible taste.
e is this—they've included
Some better things, too, in their haste.

ipped in the antimacassars,
Or sunk in a sofa of plush?
can bishop forget them,
And leave them behind in the crush?
Who'll buy?

x. It's going quite cheaply.
(It lived with stuffed birds in the hall!
e, to a mind that thinks deeply
That settles it, once and for all.)

ring (very plain, sirs!),
And *item*, a God (but He's dead!);
hall need Him again, sirs,
So—*item*, a cross for His head.
Who'll buy?

ed it again, though He's dead, sirs.
It is only the fashions that fly.
e thorns for His head, sirs.
They'll keep till you need 'em. Who'll buy?

EPILOGUE



EPILOGUE

THE REWARD OF SONG

make our music?

Oh, blind dark strings reply:
Well in a strange land
And remember a lost sky.
F of the laurel,
We know what fame is worth;
Break out of our winter
As the flowers break out on the earth.

I of the unknown comrade,
In the days when we lie dead,
In our book in the sunlight,
And read, as ourselves have read,
All, by a firwood,
With whispering seas below,
A song we made him
Ages and ages ago.

May-time sweeter
With dews of our own dead may,
Our own dead heart-strings
Awake in his heart that day,
Y for no richer guerdon,
No praise from the careless throng;

the cry of a lover

In quest of an answering song.

might run to his elders

With news of an opening flower

Walk with our young companion

And talk to his heart for an hour,

By your own green firwood,

And once by a Western sea,

By your own good comrades

Have walked and talked with me.

make men sorrow,

Too weak to heal their pain

that remember the hawthorn

May find their heaven again),

But by a deeper hunger;

We are bound by a stronger cord;

In the heart of our music,

And love is its one reward.

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